THM LAB COMPLETION REPORT

Passive Reconnaissance

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Focus: WAPT

Platform: TryHackMe.com

1. Objective — What was the task about?

The main goal of this lab was to figure out how to gather critical information about a target like its domains, IP addresses, and underlying infrastructure using purely public sources. I had to hunt down specific hidden flags by completing a series of guided tasks, all without ever sending direct traffic to the target's actual servers to avoid detection.

2. Concept/Understanding — What did you learn?

I learned exactly where to draw the line between active and passive reconnaissance. While active recon involves directly interacting with a target (which can easily set off alarms), passive recon is all about stealth relying entirely on OSINT and public databases. I got a solid grasp on how WHOIS domain registration works, explored different DNS Records, and saw firsthand how much infrastructure data search engines can publicly expose.

3. Practical Work — What did you perform?

I worked my way through the Passive Reconnaissance room on THM. Instead of running noisy scans, I used publicly available tools to footprint the target domain. I dug into WHOIS databases to pull registrar details and ran command-line DNS queries to map out mail servers and uncover hidden TXT records. I also used third-party OSINT web tools to hunt down subdomains and exposed services, crafting specific queries to track down the required flags for the lab.

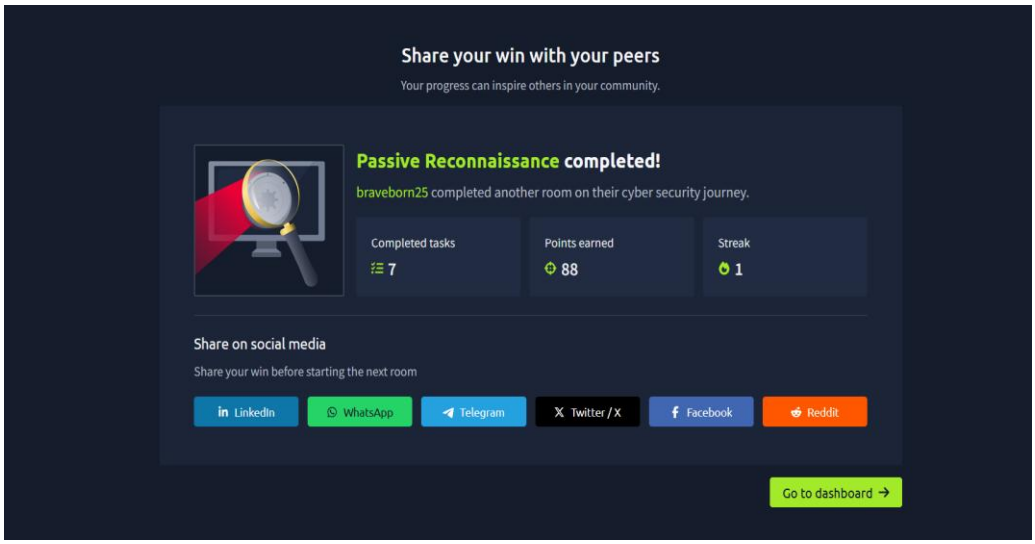
4. Tools Used — Tools used during the task.

- Basic Command Line tool:- nslookup, dig
- Whois
- Shodan.io
- DNSdumpster

5. Evidence — Relevant screenshots and results.

Screenshots of the completed TryHackMe rooms, practical exercises, and relevant results can be added below as evidence of the work completed.

1.Screenshot of room completion:-



2.ScreenShot of Whois Result:-

```
user@TryHackMe$ whois tryhackme.com
[Querying whois.verisign-grs.com]
[Redirected to whois.namecheap.com]
[Querying whois.namecheap.com]
[whois.namecheap.com]
Domain name: tryhackme.com
Registry Domain ID: 2282723194_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.namecheap.com
Registrar URL: http://www.namecheap.com
Updated Date: 2021-05-01T19:43:23.31Z
Creation Date: 2018-07-05T19:46:15.00Z
Registrar Registration Expiration Date: 2027-07-05T19:46:15.00Z
Registrar: NAMECHEAP INC
Registrar IANA ID: 1068
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abuse@namecheap.com
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +1.6613102107
Reseller: NAMECHEAP INC
```

3.Screenshot of nslookup and Dig Commands:-

```
user@TryHackMe$ nslookup -type=A tryhackme.com 1.1.1.1
Server:         1.1.1.1
Address:        1.1.1.1#53

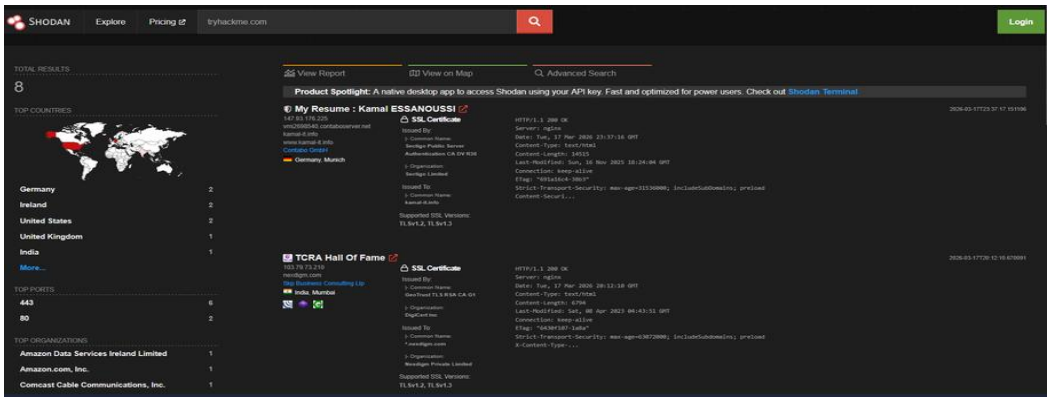
Non-authoritative answer:
Name: tryhackme.com
Address: 172.67.69.208
Name: tryhackme.com
Address: 104.26.11.229
Name: tryhackme.com
Address: 104.26.10.229
```

```
user@TryHackMe$ dig @1.1.1.1 tryhackme.com MX

; <<>> DiG 9.18.28-0ubuntu0.22.04.1-Ubuntu <<>> @1.1.1.1 tryhackme.com MX
; (1 server found)
;; global options: +cmd
;; Got answer:
;; ->>HEADER<<- opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 12345
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 5, AUTHORITY: 0, ADDITIONAL: 1


;; ANSWER SECTION:
tryhackme.com. 300 IN MX 1 aspmx.l.google.com.
tryhackme.com. 300 IN MX 5 alt1.aspmx.l.google.com.
tryhackme.com. 300 IN MX 5 alt2.aspmx.l.google.com.
tryhackme.com. 300 IN MX 10 alt3.aspmx.l.google.com.
tryhackme.com. 300 IN MX 10 alt4.aspmx.l.google.com.
```

4.Screenshot of Shodan.io:-



6. Result — What did you achieve or discover?

I successfully wrapped up the Passive Reconnaissance lab and walked away with a practical understanding of how to map out a target's external footprint completely under the radar. I am now comfortable querying domain registrars, resolving authoritative name servers, and using OSINT tools to find valid subdomains. It definitely gave me a solid, practical boost in my penetration testing and cybersecurity skillset.

7. Key Learnings — What did you learn from the task?

- Stealth is incredibly effective; you can gather a massive amount of actionable intelligence without sending a single packet to the target network.
- DNS is a Dumpster for information misconfigured or exposed TXT records and subdomains easily leak internal infrastructure details.
- Shodan.io prove that if a device is connected to the internet.
- I Gained solid hands-on experience by working through real-world OSINT scenarios.
- I Built a steady foundation for further learning in web application security and Cybersecurity.

Conclusion

This Passive Recon lab was a great hands-on introduction to open-source intelligence and target Analysis. It really made me understood how much information about organization's infrastructure is accidentally leave out in the open. Using both command-line utilities and web-based OSINT tools made it surprisingly easy to uncover hidden details in public records, and understanding how to read DNS records gave me a clear picture of how organizations route their web and mail traffic